



FLEET & SHORE PERSONNEL TRAINING

Media Handling

Dealing with the press, radio and television during and after an incident.



Emergency Response Plan

Navigate Response

Company SMS

Crisis Communications

What we will cover

01

Working with the Media

Why the media matters and what it wants

02

Handling the Local Media

Practical arrangements at the scene

03

Statements and Press Releases

What to write and what to leave out

04

Navigate Response

Our contracted media response network

05

The Navigate Response Network

Regional contacts around the world

06

Responding to Calls

Scripted answers and liaison technique



SECTION 01

Working with the Media

The press, radio and television are our principal links with the world outside the Company.

01

WHY THIS MATTERS

The media largely set the agenda for external discussion

They shape public opinion and often influence the reactions of governments to a crisis. They have a legitimate interest in obtaining prompt and accurate factual information.

Prompt

Accurate

Factual

What the media does, and why we co-operate

If the media's requirements can be met, a favourable impression can be created of a caring company seeking to respond responsibly to the best of its ability.



Our principal link to the outside world

The press, radio and television carry our account of events to everyone who is not in the room.



They set the agenda

They largely determine what the external discussion of the incident will be about.



They shape public opinion

Coverage forms the impression that charterers, ports, families and the public will hold.



They influence governments

Media coverage often drives the reaction of national and local authorities to a crisis.



The challenge

To strike the right balance between co-operating with and understanding the media's needs, and maintaining the interests of the Company. Neither shutting the media out nor telling them everything is the correct answer.

Four specific forms of communication to be managed

Every contact with the media falls into one of these four categories. Each one is prepared, cleared and recorded.



Response statements

The holding line used to answer any enquiry. Prepared first and kept updated as issues develop.



Press releases

The formal written account of what has happened and what is being done about it.



Press conferences

A managed briefing at a venue and time that we choose, not one imposed on us.



TV and radio interviews

Given only by designated spokespersons, preferably one to one rather than free-for-all.

In a word — news

Accidents, disasters, fires, loss of life and pollution are all very newsworthy. The media industry works to deadlines, and those deadlines should be identified and respected.



Information

What they need to know

- What happened
- What is being done about it
- Who is involved
- Details such as the ship's name, crew, cargo, previous and current voyage
- Data delivered promptly, clearly and accurately



Output

What they need from us

- Response statements
- Press conferences
- Regular progress reports
- Interviews
- Photographs



Facilities

What helps them do the job

- Power points for laptops
- Refreshments
- Washroom facilities
- Where appropriate, access to the site
- Access to a management spokesman, preferably as senior as possible

Do not be afraid of the media

Develop and maintain good day-to-day contacts as a norm. At the time of an incident, media contacts who are treated fairly and responsibly will generally respect legitimate sensitivities.

✓ DO

- Develop and maintain good, day-to-day contacts with the media as a normal part of business
- Treat media contacts fairly and responsibly during an incident
- Identify and respect the media's publication deadlines
- Explain the reasons whenever a media request cannot be met
- Provide facilities that help media representatives do their job

⊘ DO NOT

- Allow access to dangerous locations — it is unnecessary
- Offer witnesses who are under shock for interview
- Give comment clearly marked "un-attributed" or "off-the-record" unless there is absolute confidence in the journalist's reliability
- Refuse a request without giving a reason



SECTION 02

Handling the Local Media

Practical arrangements that keep reporters informed and keep them away from the people managing the emergency.

02

Handling the local media at the scene

Work through these in order as soon as an incident is likely to attract local coverage.



Three record-keeping rules that apply throughout

These apply from the first enquiry until the story has closed.



Log every enquiry

Keep a log of all media enquiries — who called, when, what they asked and what they were told.



Check before release

Check response statements and press releases before they are released. Nothing goes out uncleared.



Keep copies

Copies of all media communications should be kept and logged properly for the subsequent investigation.

IN SUMMARY

Consistency and accuracy of information is essential

Ensure that all facts are checked with those managing the incident. Prepare an initial response statement and a formal press release as soon as possible, clear the text with Group contacts and circulate it to designated spokespersons.

Check the facts

Clear the text

Circulate to spokespersons



SECTION 03

Statements and Press Releases

03

What a press release must contain, and the subjects it must never touch.

What a press release must and must not do



PRESS RELEASES SHOULD

- Express sympathy for any loss of life and regret for any damage to the environment, and stress the priority of avoiding any further loss or damage
- Use short sentences; avoid ambiguities and technical terms
- Be confined to the verified facts
- Explain briefly and clearly what has happened — who, what, where, when and how
- Include information about positive action being taken to manage the incident
- Include contact details for relevant spokespersons
- Be updated regularly



PRESS RELEASES MUST NOT

- Speculate on the possible cause of the incident; this will be the subject of an enquiry
- Discuss blame or liability
- Discuss costs; these sensitive issues could involve insurance considerations
- Release the names of the dead or injured until the next of kin have been informed and, where necessary, police permission obtained
- Say "no comment" — use the response statement instead

Preparing and clearing a statement

When time permits, response statements and press releases are checked with Besiktas Shipping Group before release.

1

Verify the facts

Ensure that all facts are checked with those managing the incident. Consistency between statements matters as much as the content of any one of them.

2

Draft early

Prepare an initial response statement and a formal press release as soon as possible — the first hours set the tone of the coverage.

3

Clear the text

Clear the wording with Group contacts before anything is released. Nothing leaves the office uncleared.

4

Circulate to spokespersons

Send the cleared text to every designated spokesperson so that everybody is working from the same words.

5

Update regularly

Keep the statement current as the situation develops, and issue progress reports at the intervals promised.



SECTION 04

Navigate Response

A global network of experienced maritime media responders contracted to manage the media on our behalf.

04

Media response to a maritime casualty

Navigate Response is contracted to manage the media on our behalf should an incident occur that is likely to generate media interest.



A global network

Experienced maritime media responders working from their London and Singapore headquarters, from the scene of the incident, or from our own office.



Immediate reaction

They react immediately to provide hands-on support and guidance as soon as they are notified.



Confidentiality agreement

Navigate Response has a confidentiality agreement with us. It is safe to pass them sensitive information.



Send everything you have

Pass as much information as you can. Forward any relevant e-mails received from the casualty.



Keep the updates coming

Continue to pass updates by telephone or e-mail for as long as the incident runs.



Notify all staff

Tell all staff, including office personnel and the vessel Master, that they might receive media calls about the incident.

When an event will attract media interest

Call Navigate Response on the 24/7 emergency number. In the unlikely event that this number is not answered, call the regional numbers on the following pages.



Navigate Response

24/7 emergency contact

Call	+44 7885 137 229
Bases	London and Singapore
Cover	Media response, 24 hours



Allyson Cover

Reaches the whole network

E-mail	allyson.cover@mtinetwork.com
Send	Any e-mails from the casualty
Then	Keep passing updates



Forward any relevant e-mails received from the casualty to allyson.cover@mtinetwork.com. If the media call the vessel, the bridge refers them to the office on +90 216 395 92 80.

Initial action by Navigate Response



Prepare an initial media statement

Issued only if there is media interest, agreed by us first, and given only to media covering the story. Follow-up statements are prepared as necessary and our website might also be used as a channel.



Begin media monitoring

All media including TV and radio news broadcasts and all social media channels, reporting back with the level of interest and how best to counter the story.



Field all media questions

All statements include the Navigate Response telephone numbers, which encourages journalists to call them direct after the initial flurry of activity.



Engage social media channels

As required, and responding to them as agreed with the Company.



Liaise with our response team

Working with the emergency response team to ensure an adequate flow of information in both directions.



Agree ongoing lines

Prepare and agree ongoing lines of communication and stand ready to manage requests for interview or more information. Moving to the scene is discussed according to the seriousness of the incident.



SECTION 05

The Navigate Response Network

Regional MTI Network contacts. Use these only if the 24/7 emergency number is not answered.

05

United Kingdom and Scotland

Contact	Telephone	E-mail
London office	+44 207 823 9444	london@mtinetwork.com
Patrick Adamson	+44 7836 766 947	pat.adamson@mtinetwork.com
Martin Baxendale	+44 7802 954 616	martin.baxendale@mtinetwork.com
Mark Clark	+44 7795 170 603	mark.clark@mtinetwork.com
Graham Isdale — Scotland	+44 7920 757 736	graham.isdale@mtinetwork.com

All numbers other than the London office are mobile numbers.

Continental Europe



Netherlands

Cor Radings
+31 62 63 16 854
cor.radings@mtinetwork.com



Belgium

Bart De Clerck
+32 477 673 657
bart@com-fort.eu



France — Paris

Office +33 1 42 66 35 60
Georges Laederich +33 6 14 07 05 26
georges.laederich@arjuna.fr



Italy — Milan

Office +39 02 831 0511
Martin Slater +39 348 317 5494
Antonella Romano +39 348 317 5493
martin.slater@mtinetwork.it



Spain — Madrid

Laura Grani
+34 601 532 270
laura@lauragrani.com



Greece — East Mediterranean

Marina Leonidhopoulos +30 693 739 3999
Dimitris Roulias +30 694 6799 501
mleonidhopoulos@mtinetwork.gr

Norway and Istanbul

Contact	Mobile	E-mail
Roddy Craig — Norway	+47 970 81 179	rodgy@mtinetwork.no
Steve Marshall — Norway	+47 917 88 068	steve@mtinetwork.no
Christina Dupré Roos — Norway	+47 936 34 449	christina@mtinetwork.no
Baris Karcioğlu — Istanbul	+90 533 208 6005	baris@mese.com.tr
Deniz Tanis — Istanbul	+90 533 276 9440	deniz@mese.com.tr

Marina Leonidhopoulos and Dimitris Roulias cover the Eastern Mediterranean from Greece — see the previous page.

United States and Canada

USA office: telephone +1 203 406 0106, fax +1 203 406 0110.



Darrell Wilson

Mobile +1 405 314 8536 · dwilson@mtinetworkusa.com



David Solsbery

Office +1 720 375 5172 · dsolsbery@mtinetworkusa.com



Jonathan Chia

Mobile +1 315 760 4481 · jchia@mtinetworkusa.com



Jim Lawrence

Mobile +1 203 550 2621 · jlawrence@mtinetworkusa.com



Canada

- Office tel +1 514 843 2367
- Office fax +1 514 843 6976
- Karen White +1 902 223 2782
- kwhite@national.ca

South America, Africa, Australia and the Middle East

The remaining regional contacts in the MTI Network. Call the 24/7 emergency number first; use these only if it is not answered.



South America

Ian Herbison +55 11 961 682 301
ian.herbison@speyside-group.com
Silvia Ardila +57 3107674429
silvia.ardila@speyside-group.com



Africa — Mozambique

Nic Daniel
+258 843 600 390
nic@capemar.com



Australia — Sydney

Office +61 28264 1000
James Murray +61 405 294 349
Ashley Rambukwella +61 407 231 282 A131
j.murray@fcr.com.au



Middle East — Dubai

Office +971 4 343 0888
Fax +971 4 343 2226
Melwyn Abraham +971 508 543 528
melwyn@matrixdubai.com

Singapore, Hong Kong, the Philippines, Japan and India

Country	Contacts
Singapore	Andrew Leahy +65 9773 5595 · andrew.leahy@mtinetwork.com Kenny Wan +65 8928 0280 · kenny.wan@mtinetwork.com
Hong Kong	Nick Roe +852 9081 1087 · nick.roe@mtinetwork.com Keren Zhu +852 6315 0909 · keren.zhu@mtinetwork.com
Philippines	Gina de los Reyes Virtusio +63 918 800 4462 · gina.virtusio@mtinetwork.ph
Japan	Yoshinori Fukushima +81 8051956241 · fukushima@ppc-inc.co.jp
India	Office +91 11 4940 1916 Sunil Puri +91 98 1115 3318 · puri@mileage.in Vidheesh Tyagi +91 98 1126 6564 · vidheesh@mileage.in



SECTION 06

Responding to Calls

Nobody who is not a designated spokesperson speaks for the Company. These are the words to use instead.

06

Three calls you may have to take

Use these words, take the caller's details, and pass them on. Do not be drawn into any further discussion.



A call from the media

Office and shore staff

- "Thank you for your call. We greatly regret this accident and its consequences. I am not a spokesperson for my company."
- "However, I can tell you that our emergency response plan has been activated and that our accident response team is handling the incident."
- "Please let me have your name, company name, telephone number and email address and I will ensure you are contacted right back as soon as possible."
- Pass the caller's details by e-mail to allyson.cover@mtinetwork.com.



A call from a family member

Office and shore staff

- "Thank you for calling and I fully understand your concerns and we greatly regret this accident and its consequences."
- "I don't have any further information but I will transfer you to our crewing and manning department who will be able to help you."
- "But let me note your name and phone number in case I have trouble putting you through and I will ensure you are called right back."
- Put the call through to the crewing and manning team and pass them the caller's details.



A call to the bridge

The vessel

- "We are currently involved in an incident that requires my full attention; please call our office."
- Give the office number: +90 216 395 92 80.
- Do not get drawn into further discussion, and hang up.

If you do find yourself in front of the media

This advice applies to designated spokespersons and to anyone who is unexpectedly put in front of a camera or a microphone.

✓ DO

- Be as helpful and communicative as possible
- Control the situation — you set the venue for interviews, briefings and site visits
- Where possible, prefer one-to-one interviews rather than a formal press conference or free-for-all
- Know your subject
- Select only the most competent and plausible executives to act as spokespeople
- Deliver any further information promised

⊘ DON'T

- Lie
- Speculate or forecast an outcome
- Waffle
- Give "exclusive" media stories
- Say "no comment" — use the agreed response statement

Technique in front of a camera or microphone



Demonstrate composure and control

Show an appropriate level of concern. How you appear will be reported as widely as what you say.



Avoid qualifying phrases

Descriptions such as "this was only a minor incident" are open to misinterpretation and challenge by an aggressive journalist.



Be careful of jargon

You do not want to look as though you are blinding the audience with science.



Rehearse the hard questions

In rehearsal, face up to the most difficult and controversial questions in your question-and-answer set.



Get an outside reading

Try to get an objective layperson to read through the Q&A to ensure you have not missed anything.



One agreed line, delivered consistently

You are not a spokesperson. Take the details, use the words you have been given, and pass the call to Navigate Response or to the crewing and manning team.



Navigate Response 24/7: +44 7885
137 229



Use the response statement,
never "no comment"



Log every enquiry and keep the
copies



Clear every word before it is
released